Ukraine Peace Talks Resume in Abu Dhabi

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Negotiators from Ukraine, Russia, and the United States have started new talks in Abu Dhabi about ending the war in Ukraine. Few people expect a big **breakthrough**, but American officials said both sides were privately showing 'a little bit of **flexibility**' about who would control Ukraine's eastern regions after the war.

Jared Kushner, Donald Trump's son-in-law and part of the American team, said the talks would focus on the safety worries of both Russia and Ukraine after the war.

The biggest problem is **Donetsk**, a region in eastern Ukraine now mostly controlled by Russia. Moscow has asked Ukraine to give up the parts it still holds, while Kyiv wants to freeze the **front line** and keep those areas, which it says are key to its safety in the future.

Neither side has moved, but an American official said the problem cannot be solved without first agreeing on a new plan for safety after the war. The last round of talks, in Geneva in February, ended without a **breakthrough**. European leaders, who have mostly been left out, want to take part.

Word Treasure

Negotiators -- Negotiators are people who talk with others to try to reach an agreement.
breakthrough -- A breakthrough is a big step forward that solves a hard problem.
flexibility -- Flexibility means being willing to change your mind a little.
front line -- The front line is the place where the two sides in a war meet.
Donetsk -- Donetsk is a region in eastern Ukraine.

Background you need

When countries are at war, their leaders sometimes send people called negotiators to talk and try to agree on peace.

These talks often take a long time because each side wants to keep its land and feel safe after the fighting stops.

Abu Dhabi is a city where leaders from different countries sometimes meet to talk.

Break it down

WHO: Negotiators from Ukraine, Russia, and the United States, including Jared Kushner on the American team

WHAT: They have started new talks about ending the war in Ukraine, but the two sides still disagree about who will control eastern regions after the war

WHERE: Abu Dhabi, with the biggest disagreement about Donetsk in eastern Ukraine

WHY: Both sides want to feel safe after the war, and they cannot agree on a new plan for safety

Why it matters

It matters because wars hurt families and children, and peace talks are how grown-ups try to bring the fighting to an end.

Test what you remember

1. Where have the new talks about ending the war started?

- (A) Moscow
- (B) Geneva
- (C) Kyiv
- (D) Abu Dhabi

2. What is the biggest problem in the talks?

- (A) How many negotiators will attend
- (B) Who will control Donetsk, a region in eastern Ukraine
- (C) Whether European leaders can travel
- (D) Where the next talks will be held

3. What has Moscow asked Ukraine to do?

- (A) Leave Abu Dhabi
- (B) Stop talking to American officials
- (C) Freeze the front line
- (D) Give up the parts of Donetsk it still holds

4. What does Kyiv want to do?

- (A) Freeze the front line and keep the areas it still holds
- (B) End the talks in Geneva
- (C) Hand control to European leaders
- (D) Give up all of Donetsk

5. What did the last round of talks in Geneva end with?

- (A) A deal on Donetsk
- (B) No breakthrough
- (C) A new safety plan
- (D) A big breakthrough

6. What do European leaders want?

- (A) To move the talks to Geneva
- (B) To take part in the talks
- (C) To control eastern Ukraine
- (D) To end the talks

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: D 4: A 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Moscow: It has asked Ukraine to give up the parts of Donetsk it still holds.**
2. **Kyiv: It wants to freeze the front line and keep those areas, which it says are key to its safety in the future.**
3. **European leaders: They want to take part in the talks after mostly being left out.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):